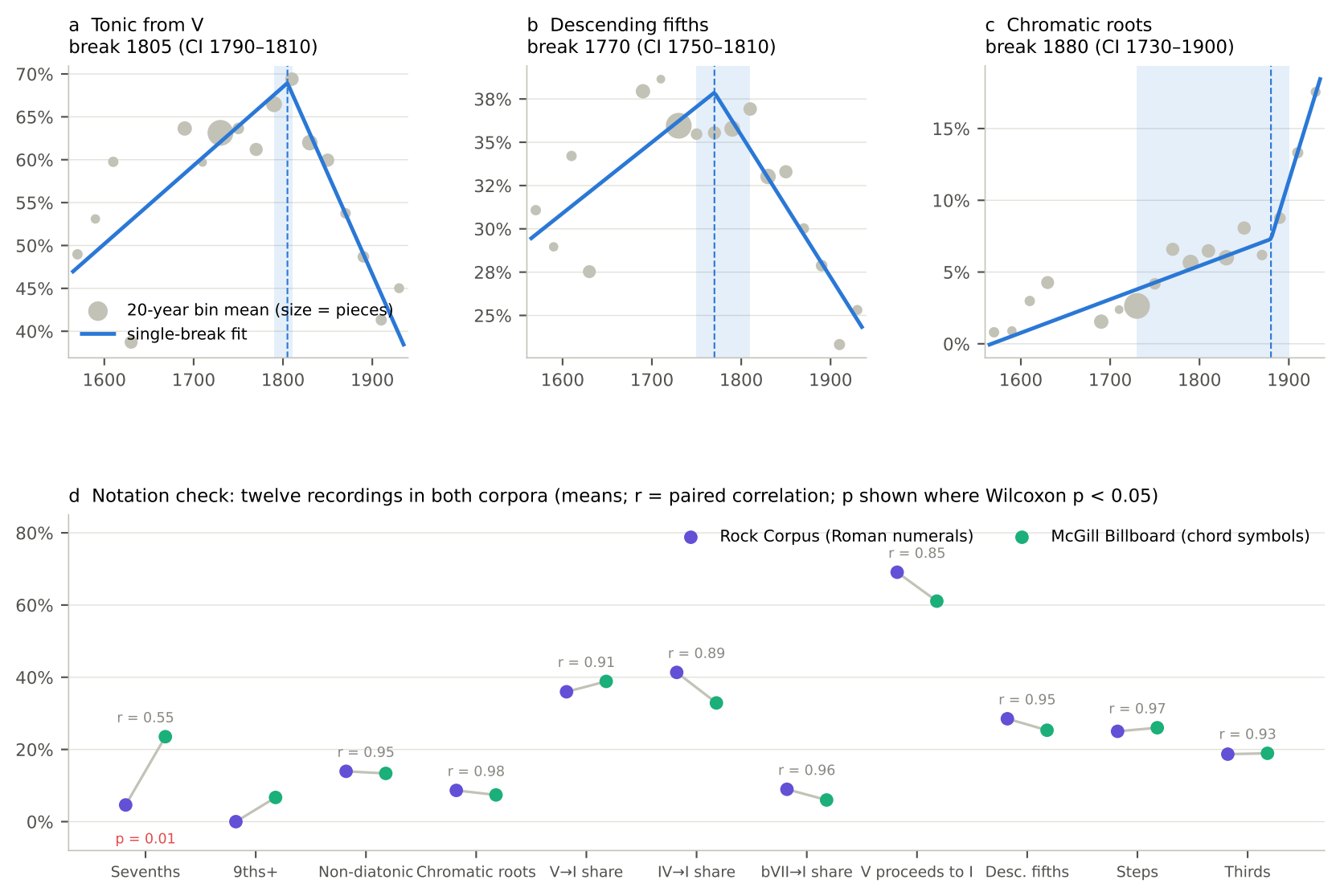
a Tonic from V
break 1805 (CI 1790–1810)
70%
65%
60%
55%
50%
45%
40%
1600
1700
1800
1900
20-year bin mean (size = pieces)
single-break fit
b Descending fifths
break 1770 (CI 1750–1810)
38%
35%
32%
30%
28%
25%
1600
1700
1800
1900
c Chromatic roots
break 1880 (CI 1730–1900)
15%
10%
5%
0%
1600
1700
1800
1900
d Notation check: twelve recordings in both corpora (means; r = paired correlation; p shown where Wilcoxon p < 0.05)
Rock Corpus (Roman numerals)
McGill Billboard (chord symbols)
80%
60%
40%
20%
0%
r = 0.55
p = 0.01
r = 0.95
r = 0.98
r = 0.91
r = 0.89
r = 0.96
r = 0.85
r = 0.95
r = 0.97
r = 0.93
Sevenths
9ths+
Non-diatonic
Chromatic roots
V→I share
IV→I share
bVII→I share
V proceeds to I
Desc. fifths
Steps
Thirds